DIAVOLA SAUCE

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	TOTAL TIME
1.6 kg	**20 min**	**1 h**

DETAILS

- Tags: vegan

INGREDIENTS

112 g	Olive oil
70 g	Garlic, 10 cloves left whole and 4 thinly sliced
113 g	Tomato paste
15 g	Crushed Calabrian chiles
4 g	Dried red chile flakes
7 g	Fennel seed
1588 g	Whole San Marzano tomatoes, crushed by hand, from two 794 g cans
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

1. Put a Dutch oven, or any heavy pot of that size, on a medium-low flame. In go the oil and the 10 whole cloves, and take them slowly to a light golden brown, caramelised and soft enough to crush, 7 to 10 minutes.
2. Crush the softened cloves where they sit, using a fork or a spoon turned over.
3. Add the sliced garlic, drop the heat to low, and give it 30 seconds to a minute, until it is aromatic but has taken no colour.
4. Stir in the tomato paste and keep it moving 3 to 5 minutes, until it darkens and has worked into the oil and garlic.
5. Add the Calabrian chiles, chile flakes and fennel seed, then the tomatoes with their juice. Stir everything together and cook 30 to 45 minutes, until the flavours have blended. Salt to taste.
6. Take it off the heat and use it, or cool it and store it.

NOTES

The heat comes from two directions: the dry buzz of dried flakes and the fruity, smoky pungency of wet Calabrian chiles. The Calabrian chiles are what give it depth, and there is no substitute that lands the same way.
The base is the same idea as the 30-clove sauce, built on whole cloves caramelised and mashed rather than sliced garlic alone.
Two garlic treatments in one pot is deliberate. The whole cloves go sweet and soft, the sliced ones stay sharp.
This runs longer than the simple red sauce, 30 to 45 minutes against 25 to 30, because the paste and the spices need the time.
Vegan as written.
Used by the rigatoni diavola.

PRESERVING

Six and a half cups, so most batches leave a surplus worth keeping.
Cool completely, then keep airtight in the fridge up to 5 days.
Freeze up to a month, portioned to one dish.
The heat does not fade in the freezer, so portion by how hot you want a dish rather than by volume alone.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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